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JANA KARIBYAN has mourned the loss of more than physical objects in her family’s Altadena home, destroyed in the Eaton fire.

What an Altadena family lost and learned in the Eaton fire

Dream home is gone, but they carry on: ‘Life is beautiful and complicated’

By JEFFREY FLEISHMAN

She comes back a couple of times a week, picking through the ash to look for things from a past life: cup, cracked plate, cheese grater, mixing bowl. The Japanese plum tree is gone. The pool is murky and dark, and she remembers how she had searched for the perfect tiles to catch the sun at certain times of day. All the doors have fallen. The chimney stands like a broken bone. It is quiet amid the black shards, the way it is after a storm.

She wipes a tear, but hangs on to her inimitable air. Her eyes match her coat, which matches her



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DEBRIS at the destroyed home in Altadena. “We’re more fortunate than a lot of people,” Karibyan says.

shoes. She is the meticulous one, the one who reads the fine print and never throws away receipts. But there is an unraveling now. The inside kind that stays with her through the day and into the night. It draws her to Altadena, to the charred earth, where once stood the home that held all she was or ever wanted.

“Is putting a mirror to the pain confronting it or making me unable to escape what we’ve lost?” asks Jana Karibyan, standing in what used to be her kitchen before the Eaton fire consumed the Janes Cottage home she moved into 14 years ago. “I look around here and see the time that went into this [See **Family**, A6]

State prisons crack down after surge in killings

By MATTHEW ORMSETH

Faced with seven homicides in the first nine weeks of the year, California prison authorities announced that they have restricted inmate movement and revoked privileges such as visits and phone calls at high-security

facilities across the state. In a statement dated March 8, officials from the California Department of Corrections and Rehabilitation cited a “surge” in violence directed at both inmates and staff as the reason for the crackdown at 11 prisons. CDCR officials declined

an interview request from The Times. Authorities are conducting a “comprehensive investigation” into causes of the violence, said Terri Hardy, a spokeswoman for the department.

At the current pace, 2025 would see nearly double last year’s reported total of 24 homicides inside state

prisons. Authorities didn’t say for how long visiting, phone use and other privileges would be restricted on high-security yards at Calipatria State Prison; Centinela State Prison; California Correctional Institution; High Desert State Prison; Kern Valley State Prison; California

State Prison, Los Angeles County; Mule Creek State Prison; Pelican Bay State Prison; California State Prison, Sacramento; Substance Abuse Treatment Facility; and Salinas Valley State Prison.

The day before the department announced the [See **Prisons**, A7]

‘A reckoning for Snap’: Parents suing over drug deaths

More than 60 families allege the company is liable for fentanyl sales enabled by app.

By MARISA GERBER

Jaime Puerta keeps a shrine to his son, Daniel, behind his desk — a collection of candles, old pictures and his son’s beloved toy car. He also keeps a stash of naloxone, the lifesaving opioid overdose reversal drug, and a yellow poster Puerta carried while marching with other grieving parents outside the headquarters of Snap, creator of the disappearing messaging app Snapchat. At the bottom of the poster is the solemn slogan of his son’s life:

“Forever 16.” Puerta is among the more than 60 families suing Snap, claiming that the Santa Monica-based company behind Snapchat is responsible for drug sales to teens that are facilitated through its app. Snap denies the allegations in the wrongful-death cases, which accuse the company of designing an app that is inherently dangerous. In a statement, the company said it removed more than 2.4 million pieces of drug-related content last year, disabling 516,000 related accounts, and noted that it blocks searches for drug-related terms and instead redirects users to resources about their dangers. The cases, filed in Los Angeles County Superior [See **Snapchat**, A9]



DANIA MAXWELL Los Angeles Times
CLAUDIA ORTEGA and husband Jaime Puerta, whose son died after taking fentanyl, console each other at a 2021 news conference for an antidrug initiative.

After blazes, support to curb housing

Poll finds L.A. voters want stricter building codes, fewer homes in wildfire-prone areas.

By LIAM DILLON

Overwhelming majorities of Los Angeles County voters support strengthening building codes and imposing greater restrictions on home construction in high-risk areas following January’s devastating Palisades and Eaton fires, according to a new poll from the UC Berkeley Institute of Governmental Studies, co-sponsored by The Times.

Eighty percent of those polled backed tougher building codes to make homes more fire-resistant even if doing so added to costs. Seven out of 10 wanted more regulations to curb homebuilding in wildfire-prone neighborhoods.

“This is a huge event in L.A. history,” said Mark DiCamillo, poll director at the UC Berkeley Institute of Governmental Studies. “It’s having a major effect on what people think needs to be done in terms of making housing safer.”

Almost 13,000 households were displaced by the two fires, which destroyed structures on 56% of properties in Pacific Palisades and nearly half of those in Altadena.

Even though implementing more robust building codes and restrictions on growth could affect Palisades and Altadena homeowners directly, voters polled in those communities supported both ideas by wide margins.

Backing for stronger building codes in the Palisades and Eaton fire zones, 85% and 82% respectively in favor, eclipsed support from other areas. For homebuilding limits, 65% of voters in the Palisades fire zone were supportive, as were 61% of those surveyed in the Eaton area.

These two issues are weighing heavily on Tracey [See **Poll**, A7]

Trump escalates his trade war

The president says he’s going to double his planned tariffs on steel and aluminum from Canada. **BUSINESS, A8**

UCLA targets antisemitism

The school launches an initiative as universities get warnings from the Trump administration. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

‘Bags fly free’ coming to an end

In late May, Southwest Airlines will begin charging customers to check luggage. **BUSINESS, A8**

Weather

Rain and drizzle. L.A. Basin: 60/48. **B6**

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